

Supplementary Tables 1, 2 and 3

Supplementary Table 1: Day-to-day context for engaging in podiatry for both Pre-FC and Post-FC participants

Motivation	Group	Median (IQR)	Mean rank	U	z	p	Effect size (r)
Contribution to society	Pre-FC	5 (4-5)	55.09	1479.5	-1.059	0.290	0.10
	Post-FC		60.24				
Skills to improve quality of life	Pre-FC	5 (5-5)	55.03	1476.5	-1.226	0.220	0.11
	Post-FC		60.28				
Build human relationships	Pre-FC	5 (4-5)	58.03	1623.5	-0.010	0.992	0.00
	Post-FC		57.98				
Work with a range of service users	Pre-FC	5 (4-5)	57.76	1613	-0.082	0.934	0.01
	Post-FC		58.18				
Work with specific groups	Pre-FC	4 (4-5)	58.85	1582.5	-0.256	0.798	0.02
	Post-FC		57.35				
Fulfilling	Pre-FC	5 (4-5)	54.22	1436	-1.393	0.164	0.13
	Post-FC		60.91				
Working under pressure	Pre-FC	4 (4-5)	59.78	1536	-0.544	0.587	0.05
	Post-FC		56.63				
Non-sedentary profession	Pre-FC	4 (3-5)	56.98	1574	-0.303	0.762	0.03
	Post-FC		58.78				
Work in a team	Pre-FC	4 (4-5)	58.31	1609.5	-0.096	0.924	0.01
	Post-FC		57.76				
Offers variety	Pre-FC	5 (4-5)	56.36	1543	-0.542	0.588	0.05
	Post-FC		59.26				

Note: IQR, interquartile range (25th – 75th percentiles); Pre-FC, before first career; Post-FC, after first career

Supplementary Table 2: How information on podiatry is accessed for both Pre-FC and Post-FC participants

Resource	Group	Median (IQR)	Mean rank	U	z	p	Effect size (r)
Health Website	Pre-FC	1 (0-1)	60.54	1448	-1.063	0.288	0.10
	Post-FC		55.13				
Job Website	Pre-FC	0 (0-0)	56.54	1552	-0.372	0.710	0.03
	Post-FC		58.25				
University Website	Pre-FC	1 (1-1)	59.10	1520	-0.629	0.530	0.06
	Post-FC		56.25				
Social media	Pre-FC	0 (0-0)	58.32	1559	-0.314	0.754	0.03
	Post-FC		56.86				
Other	Pre-FC	0 (0-0)	56.06	1528	-0.773	0.439	0.07
	Post-FC		58.63				

Note: IQR, interquartile range (25th – 75th percentiles); Pre-FC, before first career; Post-FC, after first career

Supplementary Table 3: Professional, personal and understanding barriers for engaging in podiatry for both Pre-FC and Post-FC participants

	Barrier	Group	Median (IQR)	Mean rank	U	z	p	Effect size (r)
Professional barriers	Geographical location	Pre-FC	3 (2-4)	50.13	1225.00	-1.148	0.251	0.11
		Post-FC		56.92				
	Lack of funding for second degree	Pre-FC	4 (2-5)	34.84	569.50	-0.706	0.480	0.07
		Post-FC		38.34				
	Financial support	Pre-FC	4 (2-5)	47.78	1108.50	-1.747	0.081*	0.16
		Post-FC		58.18				
	Cost of training	Pre-FC	4 (2-5)	48.41	1124.00	-1.267	0.205	0.12
		Post-FC		55.94				
	High workload	Pre-FC	4 (2-4)	54.4	1440.50	-0.904	0.366	0.08
		Post-FC		59.84				
	Perceived working conditions	Pre-FC	3 (2-4)	53.22	1367.00	-0.520	0.603	0.05
		Post-FC		56.3				
Personal Barriers	Attitudes to NHS workplace	Pre-FC	3 (2-4)	52.1	1315.5	-0.569	0.570	0.05
		Post-FC		55.43				
	Job availability	Pre-FC	3 (2-4)	49.34	1191	-2.037	0.042*	0.19
		Post-FC		61.68				
	Lack prestige	Pre-FC	3 (2-4)	58.51	1149.50	-1.511	0.131	0.14
		Post-FC		49.66				
	Lack of representation (gender)	Pre-FC	2 (2-3)	52.86	1124	-0.762	0.446	0.07
		Post-FC		48.72				
	Lack of representation (ethnicity)	Pre-FC	2 (2-3)	52.27	1143.5	-0.554	0.579	0.05
		Post-FC		49.22				
	Perceived image	Pre-FC	2 (2-4)	53.76	1271	-0.384	0.701	0.04
		Post-FC		51.54				
	Perceived difficulty of profession	Pre-FC	3 (2-4)	53.76	1409	-0.812	0.417	0.08
		Post-FC		58.63				

	Perceived course difficulty	Pre-FC	3 (2-4)	57.09	1470.5	-0.332	0.740	0.04
		Post-FC		55.11				
	Lack of accessibility	Pre-FC	3 (2-4)	47.24	1085.5	-0.087	0.931	0.01
		Post-FC		47.72				
	Emotional burden	Pre-FC	3 (2-4)	54.13	1409	-0.254	0.800	0.02
		Post-FC		55.63				
	Outside obligations	Pre-FC	3 (2-5)	47.85	1120	-1.698	0.090	0.16
		Post-FC		57.83				
Understanding barriers	Shadowing after first career	Pre-FC	3 (2-5)	52.03	1078.5	-0.838	0.402	0.08
		Post-FC		47.35				
	Awareness of profession	Pre-FC	4 (2-4)	59.08	1364	-0.917	0.359	0.09
		Post-FC		53.65				
	Accessing information on profession	Pre-FC	3 (2-4)	59.86	1133.5	-1.766	0.077	0.16
		Post-FC		49.58				
	Limited information on profession	Pre-FC	3 (2-4)	57.66	1285	-0.955	0.340	0.09
		Post-FC		52.07				
	Career advisors lack of awareness	Pre-FC	4 (3-5)	51.23	599.5	-2.889	0.004	0.27
		Post-FC		36.13				
	Misconception of profession	Pre-FC	4 (2-5)	62.24	1164	-2.06	0.039*	0.19
		Post-FC		50.08				

Note: IQR, interquartile range (25th – 75th percentiles); Pre-FC, before first career; Post-FC, after first career

Bold p values denotes significant difference between groups following Bonferroni adjustment (p = 0.008)

*Denotes p values that are approaching a significant difference between groups following a Bonferroni adjustment (p = .006)